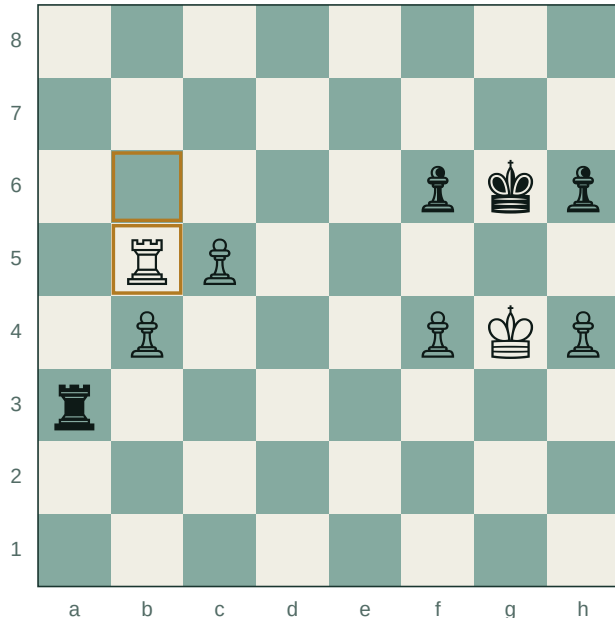


# Mate in one: Black, move 48

Mate in one

## Black to move



Previous move: 48.Rxb5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

## WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

### 48...f5#

**48...f5#** Mate: pawn on f5 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g4. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

## CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Pawn on f5. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

## CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A checking piece next to the king must be protected unless the king cannot capture it for another legal reason.

## WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Checkmate is a complete restriction of the enemy king. Find a legal check, then prove there is no king escape, capture of the checker, or interposition.

## HOW TO LOOK

Inspect the king's flight squares before choosing a check. A protected queen or a distant rook may cover the last escape in different ways.

The defending king is on g4. Geometrically undefended: rook on b5. Check for tactical protection.